



UQFC - U9-13 - Playing Through Midfield - Session 2

Category: Academy: Playing through the thirds

Difficulty: Moderate

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Description

Main Principle: Playing Through Midfield

Behaviour: Play through or around opposition to progress the ball forwards

Why? Outnumber the opposition in midfield; Create space in the middle third

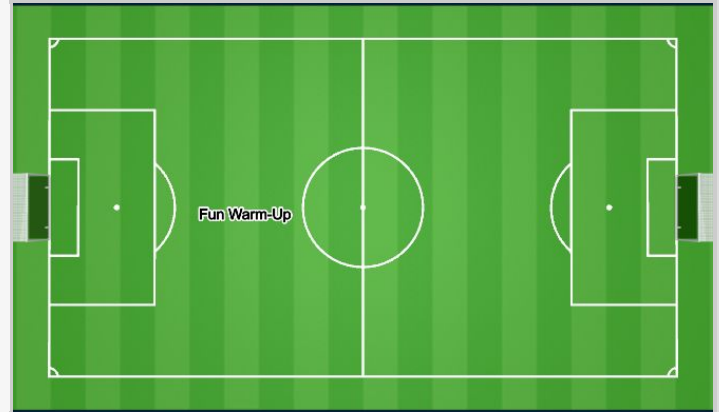
Fun Warm-Up (10 mins)

Fun Warm-Up

- The head or assistant coach leads the warm-up
- Duration 10 minutes
- Must be fun

Coaching:

- The warm-up has a gradual increase in physical and cognitive actions
- Drive the fun element of your warm-up (be the joker)
- Allow players time at the end for individual needs



Cross the River - Whole Team (30 mins)

Cross the River Positional Play

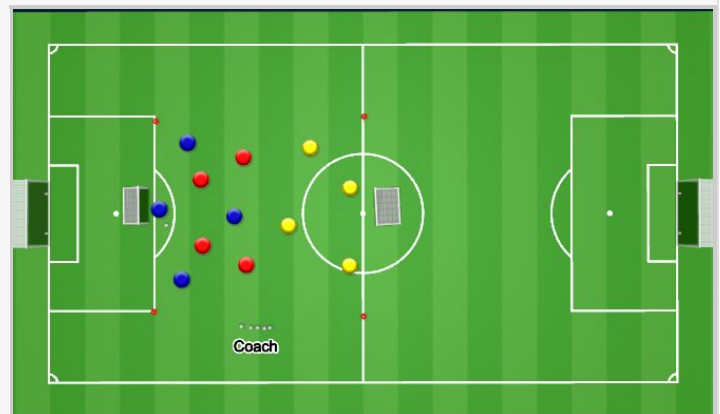
Area - Rectangular with 2x20x30m zones with 5m channel in between.

Time - 3 x 3 minutes w/ set defenders (1 game continuous 8 min with rotating teams).

Behaviour - Quickly getting back behind the ball with the team

Rules:

- Three teams, defending team, press the ball with any amount of defenders, any other defenders stay within the middle zone.
- When the defenders win the ball, they try and score in the goal from the side it came from. The team who touched the ball last before going out, now becomes the defending team, and the previous defending team replaces them.
- Attacking teams aim to transfer from one side to the other for a point, 1 person from the opposite attacking team can go into the river to help support the other team.
- A defending team will stay in for a maximum of 60 seconds, once done, the team who has been in the least, become defenders.



Coach to play ball immediately in to encourage quick recovery and transition moments.

Coaching: Use a mixture of in, over or dead-ball and use player centred techniques

- Can we look for a through pass (scan) at all times. IF we
- cannot play forwards can we play our beside pass, IF not, can we look to play behind and reset.
- Constant repositioning to create clear passing lines.
- Constant scanning and moving of body to know what their spaces are.

Water Break:

Duration 4 minutes

Big Game 9v9 - Play another age group

Area - Full-Size pitch

Time - 2 x 15-minute halves with a 2-minute break

Focus - Playing through midfield

Put subs in mini-game off to the side (coach to observe)

Coaching:

- Play 9v9/7v7 against the age group team you share the training pitch with
- Observe the playing through moments in 11 v 11 (realism)
- Encourage teams to build out and play through midfield
- Use the halftime for 2-minutes of concise feedback on a few players

